Ciana Sorrentino Wallace, MPA

Policy Analyst and Program Evaluator

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SUMMARY

Four years of research, evaluation and data integrity work at the Indiana Department of Child Services, plus three peer-reviewed publications in child welfare and public finance. Designs program evaluations, runs multi-state policy comparisons and investigates data quality in large administrative systems with SQL, R and Excel. Policy research at DCS contributed to HB 1253 being introduced in the 2026 Indiana legislative session. Most recently, independent policy analysis and evaluation work, including a multi-metro housing affordability study.

CORE SKILLS

Program evaluation design (logic models, pre/post, impact evaluation) | Multi-state and 51-jurisdiction policy comparisons | Literature and systematic reviews | Administrative data analysis (KidTraks, Casebook) | Data quality audits and AFCARS validation | Cost-benefit and multi-criteria analysis | Surveys, interviews and focus groups | Spatial analysis (ArcGIS)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder and Consultant | CSW Consulting LLC

Remote | March 2026 to November 2026

- Primary analyst on a housing affordability study for Social Impact Consultants and FHLBank San Francisco: 44+ initiatives across the Denver, Minneapolis and Austin metro areas, scored on a weighted multi-criteria framework with sensitivity analyses.
- Wage and benchmark analysis in R. Versioned Excel workbooks and Word deliverables carried through client review cycles.
- Stakeholder outreach tracking across all three metros.
- R-based assessment of gun violence data for NICJR in Prince George's County, Maryland.

Senior Operations and Research Analyst | Indiana Department of Child Services

Indianapolis, IN | February 2022 to January 2026

Research and evaluation

- Policy research that contributed to HB 1253 being introduced in the 2026 Indiana legislative session.
- Designed and ran a multi-year Mental Health First Aid evaluation for the child welfare workforce: assessment framework, quarterly impact analyses and post-implementation outcomes.
- Evaluation of Trauma-Focused Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (TF-CBT) built to Title IV-E parameters so the model could qualify for federal funding. Project tabled.
- Multi-state comparisons on acuity definitions, prone restraint, information release and supervised visitation, plus a report on how Indiana funds supervised visitation.
- Literature reviews on prone restraint, acute hospitalizations, parental substance use and guardian assistance programs.
- Fact-finding research, risk analyses for high-acuity youth placements and cross-state comparisons for the DCS Legal team.

Data integrity and systems

- Designated data champion for I-KIDS, the planned consolidation of KidTraks and Casebook into one platform (later put on indefinite hold). Validated converted legacy records, logged inconsistencies in the project tracker and was assigned to validate all Adoption and Foster Care Analysis and Reporting System (AFCARS) reports for the new system.
- Walked the data analyst for each audited area through findings at monthly project working sessions.
- Data integrity investigations and QA analyses, including a hotline data discrepancy report on intake data. Supported Office of Inspector General (OIG) audit compliance.
- Program Improvement Plan (PIP) support: heat mapping of high-acuity youth placements, placement stability metrics and the foster care workgroup.
- SQL, R and advanced Excel for cost-benefit analyses, workforce evaluations and program assessments; recommendations to executive leadership alongside legal, operations, QA and policy teams.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- **Graduate Assistant to Dr. Peter Federman**, IU O'Neill School, August 2021 to January 2023. Theory-based impact evaluation of a community center program; participant interviews; logic model and theory of change.
- **Graduate Assistant to Dr. Christian Buerger**, IU O'Neill School, August 2020 to August 2021. Co-authored a *Public Budgeting & Finance* article; research on school finance reform, tax and expenditure limits and recession effects on district revenue.
- **Research Fellow**, IU Public Policy Institute (CRISP), 2021. Logic model, pre/post assessment, interviews and intake instrument for the Immigrant Welcome Center's Natural Helpers program.
- **Research Assistant**, IU O'Neill School, 2020 to 2021. Coded state and local COVID-19 policy actions; co-authored the published user guide.
- **Climate Fellow**, Kentuckiana Regional Planning and Development Agency (KIPDA), 2021 to 2022. Regional facility data collection, an ArcGIS critical facilities solution and a presentation to the Regional Hazard Mitigation Council.

PUBLICATIONS

- Dir, A. L., Goodwin, B., Kearney, A., Sorrentino, C., et al. (2024). Front line child welfare perspectives on the utility and implementation of intensive family preservation services. *Children and Youth Services Review*, 164.
- Proving promise and support: Preliminary evaluation of the Indiana Family Preservation Services. (2023). *Child Abuse & Neglect*. Co-author.
- Buerger, C., Reitano, V., and Sorrentino, C. (2022). State fiscal reserves: Supplementation and substitution over economic boom and bust years. *Public Budgeting & Finance*, 42(1), 98 to 118.

EDUCATION

- **Master of Public Affairs**, Policy Analysis, IU O'Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs, 2022. Graduate Certificate in Environmental Policy and Sustainability.
- **Bachelor of Science**, Business Management; Human Resources Management; International Business, IU Kelley School of Business, 2019.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SQL | R / RStudio | Tableau | ArcGIS | Qualtrics | SurveyMonkey | Excel (advanced) | Word, PowerPoint, Visio, Project | SharePoint and Teams